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then Google emerged, Amazon emerged and others emerged. So, technology shakes up everything. It shakes up what the consumer proposition is, what the industry structure is, it shakes up business models and, hence, I don't see the two-wheeler market as premium scooter, mass-market scooter, premium motorbike, mass-market motorbike. The future of EV is going to be technology-led and there are two or three major technologies that will define that. One is software and the other is energy and cell. I have expertise in both. So, once we master these technologies and build a platform, we can easily build different product segments on it. And once my supply chains are at scale built out on these core technologies, it will be very hard for anybody to compete.

Q: And the third company you spoke about?

A: It is the subsidiary of Ola Electric, it is the cell one. Software is Ola's DNA, the others don't have that strength. [Our] competitors may be of the view that Ola is only assembling now [and] will do so in the future. That's not the game right now. The game right now is to control the technologies that are defining the disruption to differentiate a product better, to control your costs better, and to control your speed to market better.

Q: All the segments will be under Ola Electric?

A: Yes, we are not splitting [them].

Q: Management bandwidth for each of these will be different, right? In an earlier interview to us, you said legacy players will be surprised. We also did a story recently on Honda motorcycles and how they and Hero are challenging each other. Now, you are getting into their territory.

A: Actually, technology is getting into their territories, not me. I am just a representative of technology. If not me, someone else will enter these territories.

Q: Do you think you have an advantage in terms of scale?

A: We started only two years ago. Yeah, we attacked it with scale. And see how many scooter variants we have



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launched this year—S1 Air, S1 [and] S1's multiple battery sizes. We are able to do so many fast iterations because we control our technology.

Q: TVS has also entered the arena in a big way...

A: They are a credible company. They have a good product. It is good to have competition. My vision for the Indian industry is to be world leaders in this electrification journey. And it can't just be Ola. The whole ecosystem has to move along. Other OEMs should be building world-class products, Tier I [firms] should be building world-class components and technologies for the EV future. And that will make our ecosystem stronger. We will benefit as Ola and India will benefit, the ecosystem will benefit, and the consumer will benefit.

Q: What are the key challenges as you scale up?

A: We started our first product on August 15, 2021. It's been one and a half years. Even then, I was told that the market is not ready. But I have a different perspective. Consumers are the smartest people, they know what they want. And when they see something, they can feel what they want. It is more a supply side thing that companies were not building good enough products for consumers. Now see how EV penetration [has] scaled up since our product launch. In the premium scooter segment, the EV penetration is 90 per cent from 25 per cent before our launch, in one year. Once our S1 Air and one or two products come out at mass price points, the penetration will